

# Michael Lopez

Data Strategist · Civic Tech & Social Impact

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Data and platform engineer with six years turning public and administrative data into systems people rely on. I lead the Child Poverty Action Lab's migration of 35-40 pipelines onto Databricks, built its eviction data infrastructure from scratch, and run a production analytics platform of my own end to end.

## ■ EXPERIENCE

### Child Poverty Action Lab DALLAS, TX · 2020 – PRESENT

- **Director, Data Operations** Jan 2026 – Present
  - Lead CPAL's data platform migration to Databricks (Unity Catalog, Workflows, Lakebase + Lakehouse on AWS, Git-tracked orchestration), systematizing 35-40 pipelines from file-based storage onto unified cloud infrastructure
  - Built AI-enabled team workflows (Claude Code with custom skills and agents, prompt caching with the Anthropic API), including multi-agent code review with independent verification, accelerating how we develop pipelines, write documentation, review code, and communicate with stakeholders
  - Develop internal tools that let non-data staff act on data without analyst intervention, including a parcel-level outreach tool with 20 active field-team users
  - Maintain the eviction data workstream across four North Texas counties (~48,000 Dallas filings in 2025), feeding 12+ partners daily including the Dallas Eviction Advocacy Center and the Princeton Eviction Lab
- **Director, Data** May 2023 – Dec 2025
  - Built CPAL's data function from the ground up; led hiring for the org's first data engineer and prior analyst roles
  - Oversaw a 30+ app R Shiny suite informing decisions across housing, public safety, maternal health, benefits delivery, and criminal justice
  - Evaluated and selected the enterprise tooling stack: Databricks (over Snowflake / dbt-Cloud after a capacity assessment), Claude Enterprise org-wide, vendor data feeds (MySidewalk, DataAxle)
- **Manager, Data** May 2022 – May 2023
  - Ran CPAL's citywide risk terrain modeling on Dallas PD incident data joined to Data Axle property and business records (SIMSI), producing division-level environmental risk surfaces to target place-based violence prevention
  - Led development of R Shiny applications, shifting the organization toward interactive data products
  - Contributed to northtexasevictions.org, a public-facing eviction data transparency tool
- **Associate, Data** Jun 2020 – Apr 2022
  - Created the initial eviction data pipeline in R, laying the groundwork for the system now serving four North Texas counties
  - Built the Community Resource Explorer, indexing community-resource access within two miles of every Dallas school campus to find the least-resourced neighborhoods; helped define disbursement of a \$1.25B bond package
  - Developed dashboards and reports in R, QGIS, Tableau, and ArcGIS for internal teams and community partners
  - Automated routine data processes, establishing repeatable frameworks used across the organization

## ■ EARLIER LEADERSHIP & POLICY EXPERIENCE

### Health and Social Policy Intern, Children at Risk

Jun 2019 – Aug 2019

Led policy research on early childhood development and developed policy briefs for senior leadership and state stakeholders.

**Research Coordinator**, University of Texas at Dallas

Aug 2016 – Dec 2018

Managed the Developmental Neurolinguistics Lab; recruited, trained, and supervised 10–15 research assistants each semester and 300+ participants.

**SKILLS**

|                            |                                        |                |                   |                  |                           |         |                    |
|----------------------------|----------------------------------------|----------------|-------------------|------------------|---------------------------|---------|--------------------|
| Data Platform              | Databricks (Lakehouse + Unity Catalog) |                | PostgreSQL / Neon |                  | DuckDB                    | Polars  | PostGIS            |
|                            | CKAN                                   |                |                   |                  |                           |         |                    |
| Orchestration & Infra      | Terraform                              | GitHub Actions | Docker            | AWS              | Vercel                    | Prefect | Structured logging |
| Analysis & Languages       | R (tidyverse, sf, Shiny)               |                | SQL               | Python           | TypeScript                |         |                    |
| AI Workflows               | Claude Code (custom skills & agents)   |                |                   | Anthropic API    | Google Cloud Vision (OCR) |         |                    |
| Visualization & Geospatial | R Shiny                                | Tableau        | Highcharts        | Mapbox GL        | Spatial SQL               | QGIS    | ArcGIS             |
| Domains                    | Housing & Eviction                     |                | Public Safety     | Criminal Justice | Maternal Health           |         | Benefits Delivery  |
|                            | Community Development                  |                |                   |                  |                           |         |                    |

**EDUCATION**

**Master of Public Policy**, University of Texas at Dallas

**Bachelor of Arts, Psychology & Anthropology**, Florida International University

2015

**SELECTED PROJECTS**

- Dallas County Eviction Data.** Daily eviction-filing feed reaching 12+ legal-aid and outreach partners; ~48,000 Dallas filings a year turned into tenant outreach.
- Rental Housing Needs Assessment.** Annual public report modeling Dallas's rental supply gap; 33,660-unit shortfall at or below 50% AMI, projected to 83,500 by 2030.
- DigiLab digilab.cards.** Community-sourced tournament data platform for the global Digimon TCG scene; 5,000+ tournaments logged in six months, built and run solo through agentic workflows.

**SELECTED MEDIA**

- The Lab Report:** Data visualizations for Dallas homeless-enforcement and patrol-staffing analyses (2026)
- D Magazine:** "The Lawyer Who Landlords Don't Want to See in Court" (2024)
- KERA News:** "Eviction less likely for Dallas County tenants who get a lawyer" (2024)